Testing Ruko: a guide for reviewers and evaluators

Ruko is an Android app that notices the **moment** a scam happens on the phone and pauses the person: a stranger on a call while a bank app opens, a scam message, a fake link, an app file. It warns on the screen, reads the warning aloud, and, only if the person chose it, alerts a family member. It never blocks anything, never records calls, and never sends messages or contacts off the phone.

This guide is for **Ruko version 18 (`1.9`)** or later, the full app. Everything below was checked against version 12 (`1.3`) and re-checked on 1.9. Each sample message was run through the app's own checker before it was put here.

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1. What you need

Test phone	Android **10 or newer**. Ruko doesn't run on iPhone. On Android 8–9 it can't see who is calling, so the call tests won't work there.
A second phone	For call and message tests. Its number must **not be saved** in the test phone's contacts, because Ruko treats saved contacts as people you know.
Reviewer code	Ask the Ruko team. It unlocks the full app on the website.
Optional: a UPI or bank app on the test phone (PhonePe, Google Pay, Paytm, any bank app)	For the call tests. You don't have to pay; just open it.

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2. Install and set up (about 5 minutes)

1. On the test phone, open **getruko.vercel.app/install**.
2. Choose **Ruko (full)**, enter the **reviewer code**, and follow the steps on the page. The full app isn't on the Play Store yet, so Android asks you to allow the install; the page shows how.
    - **Already have an older Ruko (version 11 or before)?** Uninstall it first. From version 12 Ruko is signed with its own key, so Android won't install it over an older one. You'll set it up again once; later versions install over it.
3. Open Ruko and follow setup. It asks for these, each with a one-line reason:
    - **Let Ruko see who is calling** (make Ruko the "caller ID & spam" app)
    - **Let Ruko know when you're on a call**
    - **Let Ruko check if a caller is saved** (contacts)
    - **Let Ruko notice your bank app** (usage access)
    - **Let Ruko show the warning** (display over other apps)
    - **Let Ruko send you notifications**
    - **Also check your messages** (notification access). If Android says **"Restricted setting"**: open Settings → Apps → Ruko, tap the ⋮ menu at the top right, choose **Allow restricted settings**, enter your phone's PIN, then go back to Ruko and turn it on.
4. Setup also asks who Ruko should call in a warning, and how:

- **Just me:** only warns you. Pick this if you test alone.
- **Ask me first:** the warning shows a big button to call them.
- **Tell them automatically:** their phone rings. This needs Ruko on their phone too, paired with a code.

5. **Home must say "Protection is on".** If it says "Protection is off", tap **Fix it**.
6. Links: setup asks **"Check links before they open"**; tap **Allow** (Ruko becomes the default browser; it checks each link on the phone, then hands it to Chrome). Skipped it? Settings → Links. The three online checks there stay off unless you turn them on.
7. **Keep "Silent mode" off:** Settings → For testing. Silent mode logs warnings without showing them.
8. **Numbers you know and the family safe word** are no longer in setup: Home shows **"Finish setting up"** for them (optional; protection works without them).
9. **Keep Ruko running.** Battery savers on Xiaomi/Redmi, Oppo, Vivo, Realme, OnePlus and Samsung phones stop apps in the background, and a stopped Ruko can't warn. Setup has a **"Keep Ruko running"** screen: tap **"Show the steps for my phone"** (getruko.vercel.app/keep-running) and **"Open Ruko's battery settings"**, and do the steps before you start testing. If protection ever drops, Ruko shows a notification within 15 minutes; tap it, or **Fix it** on Home.

Truecaller users: Android allows only one caller ID app, and setup explains it on the "Let Ruko see who is calling" screen. You can **keep Truecaller** as the caller ID app: skip that step, allow "Also check your messages", and Ruko reads who is calling from the phone's call notification instead. A caller counts as known only if the name shown exactly matches one of your saved contacts.

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3. The rules, in plain words

Ruko only acts when a rule matches. A "stranger" is any number **not saved** in contacts.

Rule	When it fires	What you see	Family member
R1 Bank or UPI app on a call	A stranger has been on the call **2+ minutes** and a bank or UPI app opens	Red **"Pause. This call looks like a scam."**, read aloud; "Continue" unlocks after 30 seconds	Follows your choice (Just me / Ask me first / Tell them automatically)
R1 early	Same, but the call is **under 2 minutes**	Calm **"Is this someone you know?"** "No, I don't know them" turns it into the red warning	Only after "No"
R1 after the call	A bank or UPI app opens within **10 minutes after** a 2+ minute stranger call	Calm question: **"Did the caller from 4:12 pm ask you to open PhonePe?"** "Yes, they asked me" gives the red warning; "No, I opened it myself" ends it	Only after "Yes"
R2 Screen sharing	A stranger is on the call (any length) and a screen-sharing app opens (AnyDesk, TeamViewer and 26 others)	Red **"Stop. This is a scam."**	Follows your choice
R3 A code (OTP) on a call	A bank code or bank text arrives **during** a stranger's call	Red warning: "Don't share this code or OTP with anyone. Hang up."	Follows your choice

Rule	When it fires	What you see	Family member
R3 after the call	An OTP within 10 minutes after a 2+ minute stranger call	Calm question: **"Did the caller from 4:12 pm ask you for this code?"**	Only after "Yes"
Delivery codes	An Amazon, Flipkart or courier delivery code during the call	A calm notification only	Never
R4 Very long call	A stranger keeps you on a call 45+ minutes (30 for video)	Off by default; a switch in Settings sends a calm note to your family member	Only if switched on
R6 Scam message	A scam message in SMS, WhatsApp, Telegram, Instagram, Messenger, Truecaller or SMS Organizer	**"Pause. This message looks like a scam."** (red), or calm teal **"You're safe. Nothing has happened."** for known tricks that aren't urgent	Only for a fake link or app file **while a stranger is on the call**
R7 Opened a scam site anyway	You tapped "Open anyway" on a red link	Nothing more on your screen	Only in "Tell them automatically"
R8 Installing after a warning	The app installer opens within 30 minutes of an app-file warning	Red warning	Follows your choice
Link check	You tap a link anywhere (with "Check links before they open" on)	Red **"Pause. This link looks like a scam."** or amber **"Be careful with this link"**; ordinary sites open straight away	Through R7 only

Things Ruko deliberately does not judge:

- **What saved contacts write.** Their fake links and app files still warn.
- **Wording from WhatsApp businesses and registered SMS senders** (`VM-HDFCBK`). Their fake links still warn.

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4. Test A: scam messages, no second phone needed

On the test phone: **Home** → **Check a message**. Paste one message at a time and tap **Check**. You can also choose a screenshot, or long-press a message in WhatsApp → Share → Ruko.

Expected for every scam below: "This looks like a scam.", with the reason and **"The scam it matches"** (the card named in the table).

#	Paste this	Ruko should find
S1	`Dear SBI customer, your YONO account will be blocked today. Update your PAN and KYC immediately: https://sbi-kyc-update.top/login`	Fake bank "KYC expired" message (fake SBI site)
S2	`Your vehicle KA01AB1234 has a pending e-challan of Rs 500. Pay now to avoid court action: https://echallan-parivahan.in/pay`	Fake traffic e-challan (a reported scam site)
S3	`SBI KYC AADHAR UPDATE.apk`	App file (APK)

#	Paste this	Ruko should find
S4	`Dear consumer, your electricity connection will be disconnected tonight at 9:30 PM because your previous month bill is not updated. Please contact our electricity officer immediately 9876543210`	Fake "your electricity will be cut tonight"
S5	`NOTICE Maharashtra Natural Gas Limited. Dear pipe line MNGL Gas user Your connection will be disconnected tonight 09:30 PM Because your previous month Bill is Not updated. Please immediately call our bill update Officer Mr RAHUL JOSHI 9101830424`	Fake gas company: "connection will be cut tonight"
S6	`India Post: Your parcel could not be delivered due to incomplete address. Update your address within 24 hours: https://indiapost-redelivery.top`	Fake India Post "parcel stuck"
S7	`Hi, sorry, I sent a 6 digit code to your number by mistake. Can you please send it to me? It's urgent.`	"I sent you a code by mistake": WhatsApp takeover
S8	`ALERT: Your phone is infected with 3 viruses! Tap here to clean now and protect your bank apps`	Fake "your phone has a virus" pop-up
S9	`Diwali rush! Confirmed train tickets available for all routes. Pay advance to railseva.booking@ybl and get PNR in 10 min`	Fake booking
S10	`Part time job offer! Earn Rs 3000 daily by liking YouTube videos. Work from home, no investment. Contact HR on Telegram now`	Fake part-time job / online tasks
S11	`Income Tax Department: You are eligible for a refund of Rs 15,490. Submit your bank account details to receive it: https://incometax-refund-gov.in`	Fake income-tax refund
S12	`Rs 5,000 has been debited from your A/c XX1234 on 28-10-26. If not done by you, reply NO to block the transaction.`	Fake "money debited" alert that asks you to reply NO
S13	`Diwali bumper offer, extra 10% off today only: https://bit.ly/4hduPgG`	A short link that hides where it goes
S14	`Fill your KYC form here: https://kyc-form-2026.trycloudflare.com`	A temporary "tunnel" link
S15	`Pay your traffic fine here: https://echallan.party`	Fake traffic e-challan (a reported scam site)
S16	`This is CBI. Your Aadhaar is linked to a money laundering case. You are under digital arrest. Do not tell anyone. Transfer Rs 2,00,000 to the RBI verification account now or you will be arrested.`	Fake police / CBI "digital arrest"

Genuine messages: all should show **"No known scam pattern"** when pasted. They are what real messages look like **as text**. When a message actually arrives, Ruko also looks at who sent it: G1 and G3 are real only from a bank's or company's sender code (`VM-SBIBNK`), not from a personal mobile number (see Test B).

#	Paste this
G1	`123456 is your OTP for login to YONO SBI. Do not share it with anyone. -SBI`

#	Paste this
G2	`PNR:4512345678, Trn:12627, Dt:05-11-26, Frm SBC to NDLS, Cls:3A, Chart prepared. Confirmed: B2 34`
G3	`Your Amazon order will be delivered today. Share OTP 4821 with the delivery agent only at the time of delivery.`
G4	`Beta, I reached home safely. Call me when you are free.`
G5	`Police alert: never tap pop-ups saying there is a virus on your phone. Close the page and call 1930 if you lost money.`
G6	`Dear Consumer, your BESCOM bill of Rs 1,245 for Oct-2026 is due on 05-11-2026. Pay at bescom.co.in or the BESCOM app.`
G7	`Hi! The saree I told you about is on sale: https://www.nykaa.com/sale`
G8	`File your ITR before 31 July on the official site https://www.incometax.gov.in`

Check a message doesn't know who sent the text, so it judges it as if from an unknown number. A real brand's offer with a bit.ly link is flagged here, even though the same offer from the brand's WhatsApp business account isn't.

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5. Test B: scam messages from the second phone

Send S1–S16 from the second phone by **SMS or WhatsApp**. Lock the test phone or leave the chat: Ruko reads notifications, and WhatsApp shows none for a chat you're looking at.

Expected: a full-screen warning naming the sender, the app and the first line.

- **Red "Pause. This message looks like a scam."** for urgent tricks: bank KYC, e-challan, app files, India Post, WhatsApp code, virus, tax refund, digital arrest, links with no card.
- **Calm teal "You're safe. Nothing has happened."** for known tricks that aren't urgent: electricity, gas, booking, part-time job, "reply NO". These turn red if a stranger called in the last 10 minutes.
- On a locked phone, the warning waits and is the first thing you see when you unlock.

Good to know:

- **The same message isn't warned about twice within 2 hours** (WhatsApp shows messages again when you open the chat). To repeat a test, change a word.
- **G1 and G3 sent from a personal number get a warning:** "looks like a bank message but comes from an ordinary mobile number". That's intended. Real bank and delivery codes come from sender codes like `VM-SBIBNK`, never from a +91 mobile number.
- **On Android 15 and newer, code messages are hidden from Ruko.** Android shows apps like Ruko only "Sensitive notification content hidden" for a message that looks like a one-time code: no text, no sender. So G1 or G3 from a personal number is **not** flagged on those phones outside a call. **During a stranger's call** a hidden code still gives the red warning (rule R3), which is the moment a code gets stolen. This is an Android limit: Ruko never asks for permission to read SMS.
- **From a saved contact,** S4–S12 and S16 (wording) are quiet by design. The links in S1, S2, S6, S11, S15 and the app file in S3 still warn.

6. Test C: calls (second phone needed)

Call the test phone from the second phone and **answer**. Use a timer.

#	Do this	Expected
C1	Talk for **more than 2 minutes** (open it after about 2:15 on the call timer), then open PhonePe / GPay / a bank app **while still on the call**, and keep it open	About **5 seconds** later: red "Pause. This call looks like a scam.", read aloud; "Continue" after 30 s; the family member per your choice
C1b	Same, but open the bank app and close it again within 2–3 seconds	Nothing (an accidental tap)
C1c	After C1, open the bank app again on the **same call**	No second warning: each warning comes once per call, so it doesn't keep interrupting. The next call from a stranger warns again
C2	New call: open the bank app in the **first 2 minutes** (before about 1:50 on the call timer)	Calm "Is this someone you know?" "Yes, I know them" saves the number; "No, I don't know them" shows the red warning
C3	During a call, open a screen-sharing app (e.g. install **AnyDesk** from the Play Store before the call, then open it)	Red "Stop. This is a scam."
C4	During a call, get a one-time code sent to the test phone (e.g. log in to any app that texts a code)	Red warning about the code. On Android 15+ the code text may be hidden; it still counts
C5	Talk **2+ minutes**, hang up, then within 10 minutes open the bank app	Calm question "Did the caller from [time] ask you to open [app]?" Try **"Yes, they asked me"** (red warning) and, on another call, **"No, I opened it myself"** (nothing more for that call)
C6	Same, but after hang-up get an OTP	"Did the caller from [time] ask you for this code?"
C7	Call **under 2 minutes**, hang up, open the bank app	Nothing
C8	Tap **"I know this caller"** on any call warning, then call again from the same phone	No more warnings for that number. Undo: Settings → Never warn about
C9	Call from a **saved** contact, open the bank app	Nothing
C10	**You call** the second phone (its number not saved), and during the call open a screen-sharing app (AnyDesk)	Red "Stop. This is a scam." (the fake-helpline trick)
C11	**You call** the second phone, and during the call open the bank app or get an OTP	Nothing: paying or a code while you phone a shop or a plumber is everyday, so only screen sharing counts on calls you place
C12	**You call** a saved contact and open AnyDesk (family helping with your phone)	Nothing

Timing tip for C1 and C2: Ruko counts the 2 minutes from when the call is **answered**, not when it starts ringing, and a bank app counts once it has been open for 5 seconds. Opening it right at 2:00 on your screen can still land just under Ruko's 2 minutes and give the calm question first; "No, I don't know them" then gives the red warning.

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7. Test D: links (with "Check links before they open" on)

Send these from the second phone by WhatsApp or SMS, then **tap** them on the test phone:

Link	Expected
`https://sbi-kyc-update.top/login`	Red "Pause. This link looks like a scam." (uses SBI's name). "Open anyway" unlocks after 5 seconds
`https://www.nykaa.com/sale`	Opens normally
`https://bit.ly/4hduPgG`	Amber "Be careful with this link" (short link)
Same bit.ly, with **Settings → Links → "Check where short links lead"** on	Ruko asks bit.ly where it goes (without opening the page), finds Myntra's real site, and opens it
`https://kyc-form-2026.trycloudflare.com`	Amber (temporary tunnel site)
`https://my-shop-demo.vercel.app` **during a stranger's call**	Amber; the same link outside a call opens normally

Optional, off by default: **"Also check websites online"** (Google Web Risk) and **"Check how new a website is"** (sites under 30 days old get stricter). Each sends only the website's name.

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8. Other things to look at

- **Home → Scams going around:** cards for 53 current scams, with what they say, what they ask for, the red flag and what to do from an official source. **Listen** reads them aloud.
- **Can you spot the scam?** A quiz of real and fake messages.
- **Settings → Language:** English, Hindi, Tamil, Telugu, Malayalam, Kannada (the five Indian languages are marked beta). Warnings are read aloud in the chosen language.
- **Settings → For testing → Setup check:** every permission, **Show a test warning**, and the **test log** (events only, never names, numbers or message text). **Share the test log** sends it as a CSV file.
- **The helper's phone:** on the helper's Ruko page (after connecting), allow **"Show [name]'s alert on the full screen"**. Without it, an alert that arrives while the helper is using their phone shows only as a banner at the top (Android's rule); with it, it takes the whole screen like an incoming call. With the screen off or locked it is full screen either way.
- **What rings the helper** ("Tell them automatically"): a bank or UPI app, screen sharing or a code during a stranger's call; a clear scam link (a fake brand or bank site) or an app file arriving during that call; opening a red website anyway; protection switching off. A **short link** or other weaker link sign during a call warns the person but does **not** ring the family (a real shop can send those).
- **Helper told when Ruko stops** (needs a helper phone paired in "Tell them automatically"): uninstall Ruko from the test phone, or leave it switched off. After 24 hours, the helper's phone shows "Ruko on [name]'s phone hasn't checked in since…". Not instant, by design: a phone left off overnight shouldn't alarm anyone.

9. What Ruko doesn't do (so you don't count it as a bug)

- Scam calls on **Skype, Zoom, Meet or Instagram** aren't watched. Phone and WhatsApp calls are.
- **Calls you make:** only screen sharing warns, and only when the phone app shows a number that isn't saved. A fake helpline shown with a business name counts as known.
- **A saved contact's words** are never judged; their fake links and app files are.
- **Money moved off this phone** (laptop, bank branch, cash) can't be seen.
- **A brand-new scam site with an ordinary name** may get no warning: the address gives nothing away. The reported-sites list and the optional age check help here.
- **A chat you have open** produces no notification, so Ruko can't read it.
- A message that arrives in the few seconds while Ruko restarts (update, reboot) isn't checked.
- Ruko never blocks anything: the person can always continue.

10. Privacy, briefly

Ruko never listens to or records calls, never reads SMS directly, and never sends message text, contacts or numbers off the phone. If a family member is alerted, they get only which rule fired and when. Online link checks are **off by default** and send only a website's name (or, for "Check where short links lead", the short link to the service that made it). Details: **getruko.vercel.app/privacy**.

11. Sending feedback

For anything unexpected:

1. Take a screenshot of the warning, or of the message that wasn't flagged.
2. Note the time.
3. Settings → For testing → **Share the test log**.
4. Send all three to the Ruko team.

The log holds only events (e.g. `MESSAGE_SEEN … risky=LINK`), which is enough to see which rule fired.